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Jordan River Mine Operators Bid for VSE Reinstatement

By AL FORREST
Times Business Editor

Dison International Ltd. president Sidney Fowlds of West Vancouver said Monday his company is seeking to have its shares reinstated on the Vancouver Stock Exchange after an absence of more than one year.

Dison International operates Jordan River Mines jointly with Pechiney Development Ltd. Pechiney is a wholly-owned subsidiary of Pechiney Ltee. of Paris and its shares are not traded publicly.

Dison International, which has a 40 per cent interest in the operating copper mine, has been suspended since July 12, 1972.

Jordan River sells copper concentrates to Mitsubishi in Japan.

"It's a good mine in spite of the bad publicity it has received," Fowlds said.

The bad publicity includes floods, alleged violations of effluent dumping and constant reorganizing of the operating company.

The B.C. Securities Commission confirmed it had received an application from Dison International to be reinstated but would await a report from the RCMP before proceeding with the application.

Such RCMP checks are not unusual for suspended and delisted companies.

In Vancouver, an RCMP official said it might be some time in September before it would be ready to report to the commission. The police said they could not guarantee a date for the report.

Dison International began as Cowichan Copper.

In November, 1968, Fowlds and E. C. Dobell of West Vancouver reorganized the company to form Cerna Copper Mines Ltd. on the basis of 200 Cerna for each 1,000 shares of Cowichan Copper.

Dobell continues as a major shareholder of Dison International. He had been president of Cerna.

In October, 1969, Cerna was reorganized to form Crownex International Ltd. on the basis of 50 shares of Crownex for every 200 shares of Cerna.

(The Jordan River Mines assets had been turned over to Dison Development, a private company, and then the assets turned over to Crownex).

Meanwhile, Dobell, president of Crown Silver, had reorganized that company in March, 1969, to form Cerro Mining on the basis of one share of Cerro for five shares of Crown Silver.

In August, 1969, Cerro became Crownex International on a one-for-one basis and Crownex later absorbed Cerna and the Jordan River mine.

In 1971, Crownex became Dison Internaional on the basis of 10 shares of Dison for every 50 shares of Crownex.

The 10 shares of Dison International are the residue from every 1,000 shares of Cowichan Copper.

On July 12, 1972, Dison International was suspended by the Vancouver Stock Exchange for failing to file a financial statement.

When the report was not forthcoming by November, 1972, the shares of Dison International were delisted.

A Vancouver Stock Exchange official said the exchange had no choice but to delist the shares, although the company was operating a successful mine at Jordan River.

The exchange official said the only way it can enforce its rules about regular financial reporting is through suspensions and delistings.

The Jordan River mine has high quality copper ore. The underground mine is on the banks of the Jordan River near B.C. Hydro's reservoir and generating station.

The mill handles 1,500 tons of ore per day.

In April, 1972, the company began shipping copper concentrates from nearby Hatch Point to North Deutsch Affinereie of Hamburg, Germany.

This year a contract was signed to ship copper to Mitsubishi, Fowlds said, giving rise to rumors that the Japanese firm was interested in buying a piece of the mine.

However, Fowlds said his 40 per cent is not for sale. Pechiney spokesmen say their 60 per cent likewise is not on the market.

A series of physical disasters for Jordan River Mines began on Dec. 7, 1963, when the roof caved in and the mine flooded.

It took two years and $1.5 million to construct bypasses and re-open the mine.

The company operated briefly in 1966 and again in 1969. In all more than $3 million was spent in battling seepages and other problems in the underground operation.

Pechiney pumped $500,000 into the mine in 1970 but it was August, 1971, before pollution control permits were issued permitting the mine to go into operation.

The pollution problem still exists for the company. It was fined $1,001 on March 2 of this year for polluting Jordan River.

The company was charged under two counts of the Fisheries Act and was fined $1,000 on the first and a token $1 on the second.

Despite the many obstacles, Fowlds said he is optimistic the mine will become a highly successful venture.

HOW SHARES VANISH

Through a series of consolidations on the Vancouver Stock Exchange since 1968:

1,000 shares of Cowichan Copper
became
200 Cerna
became
50 Crownex
became
10 Dison
became delisted.

Dison is seeking reinstatement.

business

AUSSIE STOCKS IN MASS DIVE

SYDNEY (AP) — More than $300 million Australian, $423 million U.S., was wiped off the value of companies in Australia today as shareholders continued to pound stock exchanges with selling orders.

Today's slide brought the total market-value loss since the federal government's bu'get a week ago to $1 billion Australian.

The budget, the first by an Australian Labor government in 24 years, ended tax concessions on the mining of certain minerals such as copper and bauxite and cut investment allowances.

The Sydney Stock Exchange's market barometer, the All-Ordinaries Stock Index, tumbled 10.27 points to an 18-month low of 520.06. The index incorporates the market value of the country's 201 leading companies.

Australia's two biggest companies, Broken Hill Proprietary and the British-based Consinc Riotinto of Australia, took the brunt of the selling. BHP lost 14 Australian cents to close at $7.90 while CRA tumbled 80 Australian cents to $5.80.

MUTUAL FUNDS

MONDAY

LONDON

LONDON (CP)— Closing stock quotations in new pence unless pounds are indicated: Associated Brit Foods 52, Anglo Am of S. Africa 375½, Babcock and Wilcox 102, Barlow Rand 244½, Bass Charrington 123, BICC 133, Blyvoor 340, Boots 269, Bowater Paper 155, Brit Am Tob 254½, Brit Assets Trust 66½, Brit Leyland 25¾, Brit Oxygen 62½, Brit Petroleums 499½, Broken Hill Prop 530, Burmah Oil 410½, Canadian Pac 825, Cast 88, Charter Cons 196, Cons Gold 236, Courtaulds 132¼, Daggafontein 18½, De Beers 374, Distillers 145¾, Dunlop 85, EMI 154, Free St Geduld 920, Gen Elec 137¼, Glaxo 346, Gr Univ Strs 249½, Guest Keen 296½, Hawker Siddeley 344½, Hoover 420, Hudson Bay 870.

ICI 238, Imp Tob 87, Judge 56¼, Kloof 592½, Marks and Spencer 262, Metal Box 255½, MIM Holdings 160½, Phillips 905, Plessey 109, Poseidon 430, Rank A 411½, Rio Tinto-Zinc 228, Roan Consolidated 415, Second Scott Inv 80, Selection Trust 377½, Shell T and T 278, Tanganyika 215½, Thomson 191, Thorn 402½, Tube Investments 380, Ultramar 226½, Unilever 323½, Union Corp 332, Vaal Reef 10 7-16, Vickers 137¼, Western Deep Level 775, Western Driefontein 16⅛, Western Holdings 16⅛, Western Mine 112, Woolworth 72½, Zambian Angelo 224, Zambian Copper 73.

Bonds (in pounds): Brit Transport 47⅞, Brit Consols 22¼, Exchequer 90 15-16, Treasury 2008-12 and 50, War Loan 31¾.

Interim Listing

MONDAY

	Bid	Ask		Bid	Ask
			Honda	10	15
Acaplo	18	19	Hope By		95
Abaca	32	37	Hub Mn	20	
Abella		12	Juniper	14	15
Able Exp	7	10	Kandhr	23	
Adar Res	13½	15	Kaza Cpr	15	25
Alakon	4	6½	Keith Cp	12	15
Alberni	32	50	Kelgin	3	7
Alvila	5½	6	Kelmnt	26	30
Amalgm	2½	4	Kendal	45	50
Amber R	16	20	Kismet	11	18
Anglo Wst	4½	8	Komo Ex	2	9¾
Arc Res	37	40	Laguna	79	80
Arlan Pa	19	20	Lantern		48

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